

HARDWARE

TASK: 1

List 5 common issues users face with USB keyboards or mice on laptops, and write one possible solution for each.

No.	Common Issue	Possible Solution
1.	Keyboard or mouse is not detected	Unplug the device and connect it to another USB port. Restart the laptop if needed.
2.	Device keeps disconnecting	Check whether the USB cable is loose or damaged. Try using another USB port or cable.
3.	Mouse cursor is not moving properly	Clean the mouse sensor and use it on a flat, non-reflective surface.
4.	Some keyboard keys are not working	Clean around the affected keys and reconnect the keyboard. If the problem continues, try another keyboard.
5.	USB device works slowly or with delay	Disconnect other unnecessary USB devices and update the laptop's USB/chipset drivers.

TASK: 2

Simulate a troubleshooting flow: Your Bluetooth headphones are not connecting to your phone. Write the exact step-by-step actions you would take to diagnose and fix the issue, mentioning any settings or indicators you would check.

1. **Check the headphones' power**
 - Turn on the Bluetooth headphones.
 - Check the **power/battery indicator**. Charge them if the battery is low.
2. **Turn Bluetooth ON**
 - Open the phone's **Settings** → **Bluetooth**.
 - Make sure Bluetooth is switched **ON**.
3. **Put headphones into pairing mode**
 - Press and hold the **Power/Bluetooth button** until the Bluetooth indicator starts **flashing**.
 - A flashing light usually indicates that the headphones are ready to pair.
4. **Check the available devices**
 - In the phone's Bluetooth settings, look under **Available Devices**.
 - Find the name of your headphones and tap on it.
5. **Check the pairing request**
 - If a **Pair/Connect** or PIN request appears, accept it.
 - Wait until the status changes to **Connected**.
6. **If the headphones are already saved**
 - Tap the headphones' name and select **Forget/Unpair**.
 - Turn Bluetooth off and on again.
 - Put the headphones back into pairing mode and search for them again.
7. **Check if headphones are connected to another device**
 - Turn Bluetooth off on nearby laptops, tablets, or other phones that may have previously connected to the headphones.
 - Try pairing again with your phone.
8. **Restart both devices**
 - Turn the headphones off and on.
 - Restart the phone and repeat the Bluetooth pairing process.
9. **Check the phone's audio output**
 - After connecting, play a song or video.
 - Open the phone's **Media Output/Audio Output** option and make sure the Bluetooth headphones are selected.
10. **Reset the headphones if necessary**
 - If they still do not connect, perform the manufacturer's **Bluetooth/factory reset** procedure.
 - Then put them into pairing mode and try connecting again.

Final check: The troubleshooting is successful when the headphones appear under **Paired/Connected Devices**, show a connected Bluetooth indicator, and audio plays through the headphones.

TASK: 3

A user reports that their external webcam is not detected during a Zoom call on Windows 10. Write a checklist of 6 things to check or try to resolve the problem.

Hint: Consider device manager, privacy settings, and app permissions.

☐ **1. Check the USB connection**

Unplug the webcam and reconnect it to another USB port. Make sure the webcam's indicator light turns on, if it has one.

☐ **2. Check Device Manager**

Right-click **Start** → **Device Manager** → **Cameras/Imaging Devices**. Check whether the webcam appears. If it has a warning symbol, update or reinstall its driver.

☐ **3. Check Windows Camera Privacy Settings**

Go to **Settings** → **Privacy** → **Camera** and make sure **Allow access to the camera on this device** is turned on.

☐ **4. Allow apps to access the camera**

In **Settings** → **Privacy** → **Camera**, turn on **Allow apps to access your camera** and ensure desktop apps are allowed to use the camera.

☐ **5. Select the correct camera in Zoom**

Open **Zoom** → **Settings** → **Video** and check the **Camera** dropdown. Select the external webcam instead of the laptop's built-in camera.

☐ **6. Close other apps and restart**

Close applications such as Skype, Microsoft Teams, or the Windows Camera app that may be using the webcam. Restart Zoom and, if necessary, restart the computer.

TASK:4

You are helping a friend whose printer is showing 'offline' status on their PC. Describe how you would use the Windows Troubleshooter tool to try to fix the issue, and explain what information the tool provides during the process.

Using Windows Troubleshooter to Fix an Offline Printer

I would follow these steps:

1. **Check the printer first**
 - Make sure the printer is switched **ON** and connected to the PC through USB or the same Wi-Fi network.
 - Check that there are no paper jams or error messages on the printer.
2. **Open Windows Settings**
 - Click **Start** → **Settings** → **Devices** → **Printers & scanners**.
 - Select the printer that is showing **Offline**.
3. **Run the Troubleshooter**
 - Select **Manage** and look for the **Troubleshoot** option.
 - Follow the instructions shown by Windows to diagnose the printer problem.
4. **Allow Windows to check for problems**
 - The troubleshooter checks common issues such as the printer connection, printer settings, drivers, and whether the printer is available to Windows.
5. **Review the results**
 - Windows displays the **problem it detected**, if any.
 - It may also show whether the problem was **fixed automatically** or requires the user to take further action.
6. **Apply the recommended fix**
 - If Windows suggests a solution, such as setting the printer as the default printer, clearing a print queue, or correcting a connection problem, follow the instructions provided.
7. **Test the printer**
 - After troubleshooting, send a **test page** to check whether the printer is back online and working correctly.